Responsible Administrator: Provost
Responsible Office: Provost
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Selection of Department Heads

Policy Statement

Serving a dual role as faculty member and administrator of the department, the Department Head is a key position in the management of Southeastern Louisiana University. The successful academic and administrative performance of an academic department head is vital to the accomplishment of the mission and vision of not only the department, but also the college and the University. As such, Southeastern is committed to recruit and hire the best complement of our faculty and academic staff.

Purpose of Policy

This policy describes a process to ensure a wide variety of opinion and input from all full-time faculty in the selection of their academic department head. All department heads employed at the University are appointed in accordance with the University of Louisiana System bylaws and rules, Part II, Chapter III, Section II: Personnel Actions.

Applicability

This policy applies to all academic department head positions at Southeastern Louisiana University.

Policy Procedure

Selection of Department Heads

1. Administrative positions are at-will appointments – individuals in these roles serve at the pleasure of the University of Louisiana System Board of Supervisors based on official recommendations made through the supervisory chain through the president of the University. When the dean elects not to recommend reappointment, or when vacancies in the office of a department head occur, the dean shall initiate the formation of a departmental screening committee and appoint a temporary replacement, when needed, in consultation with departmental faculty.
2. The department head screening committee shall consist of five to seven members. Typically, a majority will be full-time tenured or tenure-track faculty from the department. The committee shall also include at least one full-time instructor, when possible. The committee may include a department head from outside the department, at the dean's discretion. Faculty who intend to be candidates and those who are on official leave may not serve on the screening committee.
3. As its first order of business, the committee shall elect a chairperson from the full-time tenured or tenure track faculty by a majority vote.
4. There shall then commence a specified time period for formulation of a job description (approved by the dean, Provost, and President), initiation of a national search, and submission to the chairperson of the screening committee of letters of application, vitae, and other pertinent information.
5. After the deadline for applications has passed, the screening committee shall meet to review credentials:
    a. After the candidates' credentials have been reviewed, the screening committee, if it consists of less than all full-time faculty, shall schedule a meeting with all full-time faculty to apprise them of the status of the search.

b. The screening committee shall consult with the dean to select the candidates to be interviewed and to schedule interviews.
c. All full-time faculty will have the opportunity to meet the candidates during the on-campus interviews and to provide input regarding the strengths, weaknesses, and acceptability of the candidates.

6. At the conclusion of the search process, the screening committee shall meet to cast a secret ranked poll. The chairperson shall submit to the dean the names of up to three acceptable candidates, unranked, accompanied by a narrative assessment of the candidates, indicating their strengths and weaknesses.
7. The dean shall review the screening committee's recommendations and meet with the committee to discuss each candidate's strengths and weaknesses. From the committee's list, the dean shall make a formal recommendation to the Provost concerning the appointment of the department head. The dean may elect not to select a candidate and instead recommend reopening the search.
8. The Provost shall make a formal recommendation to the President, who may appoint the department head, subject to approval of the University of Louisiana System Board of Supervisors.
9. If the President does not wish to appoint a department head from the candidates recommended by the screening committee, he/she shall order the committee to reconvene in order to recommend a different group of candidates or reopen the search process.

[End of Policy]